MENTORQUE | RESUME BLUEPRINT

Product Management • Project Management • Customer Success

PART 1 — GENERAL RESUME GUIDELINES

1.1 The Non-Negotiables

- One page — always. The only exception is 8+ years of directly relevant, non-repetitive experience. Two pages is a privilege, not a default.
- Font: Calibri, Arial, or Garamond. Size 10–11 pt for body; 13–14 pt for name. Never decorative, never Comic Sans.
- Margins: 0.5"–0.75" on all sides. Below 0.5" signals desperation; above 1" wastes space.
- Send as PDF every time — unless the employer explicitly asks for .docx. PDF locks formatting across all devices and OS.
- File name: FirstName_LastName_Role_Resume.pdf. Never 'CV_final_v4_USE THIS.pdf'.
- Zero photos, zero graphics, zero icons, zero borders — unless you are submitting a design portfolio where visual sense IS the work product.
- Never write 'References available upon request'. Every recruiter knows. It wastes a full line.
- No 'I', 'my', or 'we' anywhere. Every line starts with an action verb or a strong noun phrase.
- Consistent tense: current role in present tense, all previous roles in past tense. Mixing tenses signals carelessness.

1.2 Appearance & Alignment

- Every section heading must look identical — same font size, same weight, same color. Inconsistency implies you cut-and-pasted from multiple templates.
- Dates are always right-aligned on the same line as company or institution. Never on a separate line below.
- White space is a design tool — 4–6 pt spacing between bullets, 10–14 pt between sections. A dense page is unreadable at a 6-second glance.
- Bold only four things: company/institution names, your job titles, degree names, and critical technology names used as anchors in experience bullets. Bold is not emphasis — it is scannability.
- All bullet points at the same left indent — misalignment is the first thing a recruiter's eye catches.
- Left-align all body text. Full justification creates uneven word spacing that reduces readability on screen.
- Use one bullet style throughout: round bullet or em-dash. Never arrows, checkmarks, or stars in the body.

1.3 Section Order

- Standard order: Contact Information → Professional Summary → Skills & Technical Expertise → Work Experience → Education → Certifications → Projects / Publications (if applicable).
- 0–2 years experience: Education may come before Work Experience. Beyond that, experience leads.
- Only include a section if you can fill it with quality content. A thin 'Awards' section with one entry from 2015 hurts more than it helps.
- Hobbies/Interests: include only if they are directly relevant (e.g., open-source contributor, published researcher, competitive coder on Codeforces).

1.4 ATS Compatibility

- ATS (Applicant Tracking System) scans your resume before any human sees it. Most companies above 50 employees use one. If the ATS can't parse you, no human ever reads you.
- Never put contact info, job titles, or skills inside headers, footers, or text boxes — ATS parsers skip them entirely.
- Avoid multi-column layouts unless you're certain of the application channel. Two-column resumes frequently parse out of order in ATS.
- Spell out acronyms on first use: 'Natural Language Processing (NLP)'. ATS matches strings — 'NLP' and 'Natural Language Processing' are different strings.

- Mirror keywords from the job description exactly: if the JD says 'stakeholder management', don't write 'stakeholder engagement' — ATS won't equate them.
- Use standard section labels: 'Work Experience', 'Education', 'Skills'. Creative headers like 'My Journey' or 'What I've Built' confuse parsers.
- No images, charts, tables (for skills), or graphical skill bars — all render as blank or garbled in ATS.

1.5 Contact Section

- Line 1: Full name in the largest font on the page (13–16 pt, bold). This is the one place size hierarchy is non-negotiable.
- Line 2: Phone | Professional Email | City, Country | LinkedIn URL | GitHub / Portfolio (if applicable).
- Email must be professional: firstname.lastname@gmail.com. Anything with nicknames, numbers, or old university handles damages credibility before the recruiter reads a single line.
- LinkedIn URL: customize it to linkedin.com/in/firstname-lastname. The default alphanumeric string looks unfinished.
- City and country only — no street address. Nobody mails you an offer letter.
- No date of birth, no marital status, no nationality, no photograph — unless you are applying in a region where this is legally required (e.g., certain MENA or European markets).

PART 2 — PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

2.1 What It Is & Why It Matters

- The recruiter spends 6–10 seconds on first scan. The summary is the only section guaranteed to be read in that window — it decides whether the rest gets read at all.
- It is NOT an objective statement ('Seeking a challenging role where I can grow'). That phrasing is pre-2000s and signals no self-awareness.
- Think of it as a compressed pitch: who you are at your professional peak, the most valuable thing you have done, and the direction you are headed.
- Tailored to every role. A generic summary is the single biggest wasted opportunity on a resume. If your summary reads the same for 10 different jobs, it's working for none of them.
- Length: 3–4 lines, always. Two lines is too thin; five lines is an essay.

2.2 The Formula

LINE 1 — Identity: [X years] + [role/title] + [domain/industry] + [2 defining strengths]

LINE 2 — Proof: One concrete achievement with a number, scale, or named outcome. This is your hook.

LINE 3 — Direction: What problem you solve best + the kind of team/environment where you generate most value.

- Line 1 establishes your category. Recruiters think in buckets — make it instantly clear which bucket you belong in.
- Line 2 is your proof point. One strong metric beats five vague claims. If you have no metric yet, use scope: team size, user base, budget, geography.
- Line 3 is forward-facing. It tells the recruiter you have a perspective on your work — not just a job history.
- Strip every cliché: 'hardworking', 'team player', 'passionate', 'detail-oriented', 'results-driven'. These words appear on 90% of resumes and add zero signal.
- Read it aloud. If any sentence sounds like a brochure, rewrite it in plain human language.

PART 3 — EDUCATION

3.1 Format

Degree, Major | Institution Name **Month Year**

GPA: X.X / 4.0 (include only if 3.5+ or distinction equivalent) | Honors / Scholarship (if notable)

- Degree and major first, institution second, graduation year right-aligned — always in this order.
- Include GPA only when it is a genuine strength: 3.5+/4.0, 8.5+/10, First Class, or Distinction. A middling GPA draws attention to a gap. Omit it; recruiters do not ask.
- Honors and scholarships: include when notable — 'Dean's List (4 semesters)', 'National Merit Scholar', 'Full Government Scholarship'. One-time, small-scale awards from 10 years ago: leave off.
- Relevant Coursework: use only for freshers or career changers bridging a technical gap. Maximum 5 courses. Format as a comma-separated inline list, not bullets.
- For experienced professionals (5+ years): education is 2–3 lines max. No coursework, no grade details. Your work speaks louder.
- Multiple degrees: most recent first. Omit high school once you have a college degree (unless you went to an institution where it carries signal, e.g., certain international prep schools).
- Bootcamps, MOOCs, and online credentials belong in Certifications, not Education — unless the bootcamp IS your primary qualification.

PART 4 — CERTIFICATIONS & CREDENTIALS

4.1 Format & Rules

Certification Name | Issuing Body | Year (add 'In Progress' if pending)

- Only list industry-recognized credentials. A Udemy certificate is a course completion, not a certification. The distinction matters to technical recruiters.
- Maximum 4–5 certifications. If you have 12, list the 4 most recent and most role-relevant. A wall of certifications reads as credential-collecting, not expertise.
- Never list 'Microsoft Office Specialist' or 'Google Digital Garage' on a senior resume — they imply a skills floor, not a ceiling.
- Certifications in progress: include them — 'AWS Solutions Architect Associate (In Progress, Expected Jun 2025)' — they demonstrate direction and initiative.
- Expiry dates: include only in regulated fields (e.g., PMP renewal, security clearances, medical/legal credentials). Otherwise, the year of issue is sufficient.

PART 5 — TAILORING, SUBMISSION & FINAL CHECKS

5.1 Tailoring for Every Application

- Read the job description twice. First pass: understand the role. Second pass: extract the top 6–8 required skills, tools, and outcomes.
- Mirror JD language in your summary, skills, and top 2–3 bullets. Not paraphrased — exact terms. ATS matches strings.
- Reorder your skills section so the most JD-relevant category appears first.
- Swap in 1–2 role-specific bullets you have prepared in a 'backup bullet bank' — a separate document where you keep 3–5 additional bullets per role that didn't fit the one-page constraint.
- Rewrite your summary for every application. This is 10 minutes of work. It is also the single highest-ROI activity in job searching.
- Time investment per application: 15–20 minutes of tailoring is the difference between a 2% and a 25% response rate.

5.2 The 10-Second Scan Test

- Open your resume. Set a 10-second timer. Look at it fresh. What registers immediately?
- Your name, current title, and most recent company should be instantly legible without searching.
- At least one metric (%, $, scale) should be visible in the first 3 bullets of work experience without zooming.
- If the page looks like a grey block of text — restructure. More white space, shorter bullets, bolder company names.
- Have one person who doesn't know your career history read it for 10 seconds and tell you what you do. If they can't, the summary and top section need rewriting.

5.3 Pre-Submission Checklist

- ✓ One page (or genuinely justified two pages for 8+ year profiles).
- ✓ No typos — spell-check and then manually read every line, top to bottom.
- ✓ Consistent tense: present for current role, past tense for all previous roles.
- ✓ Every bullet leads with an action verb. Zero instances of 'Responsible for' or 'Worked on'.
- ✓ Every bullet contains at least one quantifier or meaningful scope qualifier.
- ✓ Date format consistent throughout (e.g., 'Jan 2022' — not mixing 'January 2022' and '01/22').
- ✓ LinkedIn URL is customized and the profile is live and complete.
- ✓ PDF opens correctly and maintains formatting on both desktop and mobile.
- ✓ File named: FirstName_LastName_Resume.pdf.
- ✓ Top 6 keywords from the target JD appear naturally in the resume.

5.4 Universal Resume Mistakes

✗ Stop Doing This	✓ Do This Instead
Objective statement: 'Seeking a challenging role where I can grow'	3-line tailored summary: title + proof metric + direction
Skill bars, star ratings, or proficiency percentages	Grouped skill categories, clean comma-separated list
'Responsible for managing...' / 'Worked on...'	Strong past-tense action verb + specific outcome
Duties listed without a single outcome or result	STAR-format bullets: action + scope + quantified result
No numbers anywhere — no %, $, time saved, or scale	Every role has at least one number: revenue, %, users, time
Identical resume sent to every job application	15-minute tailored version per application, every time
Three-page resume with two years of experience	1 tight, dense, high-signal page — 2 only if truly warranted
'References available upon request' — wastes space	Remove it entirely — it occupies prime real estate
Soft skills section: 'Teamwork, Communication, Leadership'	Let the bullets prove soft skills — never claim them
Random bold text used for emphasis instead of scannability	Bold only: company names, job titles, key tech anchors

PART 6 — PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY (Non-Tech Roles)

6.1 What Recruiters Look for in PM / CS / PjM Summaries

- Outcome ownership: did you define and own the result, or did you support someone else's result? Summaries must claim ownership — not support.
- Stakeholder scope: how many teams, functions, or external partners did you work across? Breadth of coordination signals seniority.
- Domain fluency: PM summaries must name the product type (B2B SaaS, marketplace, fintech, consumer); PjM summaries must name the project type (IT, infrastructure, digital transformation); CS summaries must name the segment (SMB, mid-market, enterprise) and industry.
- Revenue or retention signal: for PM/CS, ARR, NRR, churn rate, and expansion revenue are the most powerful metrics. For PjM, project value ($) and on-time delivery are equivalent.

6.2 Summary Formula — Product Manager

[X-year] Product Manager with a track record of [product area: 0-to-1 launches / growth / platform / API products] in [sector: B2B SaaS / consumer / marketplace].

[Strongest shipped outcome: feature/product launched + user or revenue metric, e.g., ARR generated, DAU grown, retention improved].

Skilled at [PM strength: roadmap prioritization / user research synthesis / cross-functional alignment] and [tools: JIRA, Figma, Amplitude, SQL for analysis].

6.3 Summary Formula — Project Manager

[X-year] [PMP-certified / Agile] Project Manager with a record of delivering [project type: IT / infrastructure / digital transformation / ERP] projects [on time / under budget] for [sector: BFSI / healthcare / manufacturing / public sector].

[Budget scale managed] across [geography / number of teams / project count]. [Risk or stakeholder management achievement].

Experienced in [methodology: Agile/Waterfall/Hybrid] and [specialty: vendor management / programme governance / change management] for [org size: enterprise / SME].

6.4 Summary Formula — Customer Success Manager

[X-year] Customer Success Manager with expertise in [segment: enterprise / mid-market / SMB] SaaS account management across [domain: HR tech / fintech / DevTools / martech].

[Strongest metric: NRR maintained / churn reduced / GRR maintained / expansion ARR generated / book of business size managed].

Skilled at [CS strength: executive business reviews / onboarding / product adoption / renewal negotiation] with a proven ability to [outcome: reduce time-to-value / expand accounts / recover at-risk relationships].

6.5 Worked Examples

Product Manager — Growth (3–5 years)

Product Manager with 4 years driving growth and engagement for B2C consumer apps. Shipped a personalized recommendation engine that increased DAU by 31% and session length by 18%, contributing to a $4.2M ARR uplift in the first two quarters. Expert at running structured A/B tests, synthesizing user research at scale, and aligning engineering, design, and marketing teams toward shared OKRs.

Project Manager — Infrastructure (6+ years)

PMP-certified Project Manager with 7 years delivering $1M–$8M infrastructure and digital transformation programmes for BFSI and healthcare clients across South Asia and the Middle East. Consistent record of on-time delivery (92% milestone adherence across 14 projects) and budget control (average 9% under budget). Expert in hybrid Agile-Waterfall delivery, executive steering committee governance, and cross-border vendor management.

Customer Success Manager — Enterprise SaaS (3–5 years)

Enterprise Customer Success Manager with 4 years managing a $6M ARR book of business across 18 strategic accounts in the HR tech sector. Maintained 112% NRR and reduced voluntary churn from 14% to 6% over two years through proactive health monitoring, executive relationship management, and structured QBRs. Recognized for consistently expanding accounts through use-case expansion and multi-product adoption plays.

PART 7 — SKILLS & EXPERTISE (PM / PjM / CS)

7.1 Product Manager Skills

Product Execution: JIRA, Confluence, Productboard, Linear, Notion, Monday.com

Design & Research: Figma, Miro, UserTesting, Dovetail, Maze, Hotjar

Analytics: SQL (intermediate), Amplitude, Mixpanel, Google Analytics, Heap, Looker

Frameworks: Agile/Scrum, JTBD, OKRs, RICE Prioritization, ICE Scoring, Design Thinking

Experimentation: A/B Testing, Feature Flags (LaunchDarkly), Hypothesis Framing

Domain: B2B SaaS / Payments / Marketplace / Consumer / API Products (list what applies)

7.2 Project Manager Skills

Methodologies: Agile (Scrum, Kanban), Waterfall, PRINCE2, PMP, Six Sigma (Green Belt)

PM Tools: MS Project, Smartsheet, JIRA, Asana, Monday.com, Trello, Wrike

Reporting & Docs: Confluence, SharePoint, Power BI (reporting), Excel (advanced), Visio

Programme Skills: Budget Management, Risk & Issue Logs, RAID, Change Control, RACI

Stakeholder Mgmt: Executive Steering Committees, Vendor Management, Contract Negotiation

Domain: IT Delivery / Digital Transformation / Infrastructure / ERP / Change Management

7.3 Customer Success Manager Skills

CRM & CS Platforms: Salesforce, HubSpot, Gainsight, ChurnZero, Totango, Planhat

Communication: Executive QBRs, EBRs, Success Plans, Renewal Playbooks, Stakeholder Mapping

Analytics: Salesforce Reporting, Looker, Tableau, Excel (advanced), Health Score Modelling

CS Frameworks: SPICED, MEDDIC, Customer Health Scoring, Expansion Plays, Churn Prevention

Product Knowledge: Product Adoption Tracking, Onboarding Design, Feature Advocacy, VOC Programs

Domain: HR Tech / Fintech / DevTools / Martech / CX (list your actual domain)

- Avoid generic soft skill clusters like 'Communication, Leadership, Teamwork' — every candidate lists these. Your bullets must prove soft skills; never claim them in the skills section.
- For PM and CS: if you can write SQL for analysis, say so. 'SQL (intermediate queries for product analytics)' is a meaningful differentiator in a field where most candidates cannot query data independently.

PART 8 — WORK EXPERIENCE (PM / PjM / CS)

8.1 Role Header Format

Senior Product Manager | Company Name (Series B B2B SaaS, 180 employees) Jul 2021 – Present

City, Country (or 'Remote')

8.2 The PM Bullet Framework

STRUCTURE: [Action Verb] + [What product/feature/initiative] + [Cross-functional context / decision method] + [User / business outcome]

EXAMPLE: Defined and launched a self-serve onboarding flow (PRD → Figma → A/B test, n=12K users), reducing median time-to-first-value from 9 days to 22 hours and increasing D30 retention by 14 percentage points.

8.3 The PjM Bullet Framework

STRUCTURE: [Action Verb] + [Project name / type + scale: budget, team size] + [Delivery context: on-time, under-budget, specific challenge overcome] + [Business outcome]

EXAMPLE: Delivered a $4.8M Salesforce CRM implementation for 1,200-user financial services firm across 3 countries, 5 weeks ahead of schedule and 11% under budget, enabling a consolidated 360 customer view that reduced average customer onboarding time by 8 days.

8.4 The CS Bullet Framework

STRUCTURE: [Action Verb] + [What CS motion: QBR / health monitoring / onboarding / renewal / upsell] + [Account context: ARR, segment, number of accounts] + [Retention or expansion outcome]

EXAMPLE: Developed and executed a structured 90-day onboarding programme for 12 new enterprise accounts ($2.4M combined ARR), achieving 94% feature adoption by day 90 and reducing time-to-first-value from 6 weeks to 18 days.

8.5 Key Metric Dimensions by Role

Product Manager

- ADOPTION: DAU/MAU growth (%), feature adoption rate (%), time-to-first-value reduced. Adoption is the primary signal that a product decision worked.

- REVENUE: ARR generated or influenced ($), conversion rate lifted (%), ARPU increased, GMV growth. Commercial impact elevates a PM from feature-shipper to business driver.
- RETENTION: D7/D30 retention improvement, NPS delta, churn reduction (%). Retention metrics are the most defensible signals of product quality.
- VELOCITY: Features shipped per quarter, cycle time reduced (days), A/B tests run. Shows execution cadence.

Project Manager

- DELIVERY: On-time delivery rate (%), weeks/months ahead of schedule, number of projects delivered concurrently.
- BUDGET: % under budget, absolute savings ($K), contract cost negotiated. Budget control is the single most important PjM KPI for executive stakeholders.
- RISK: Risks mitigated (how many, $ value of delays prevented), issues resolved without escalation, change requests managed.
- SCALE: Project value ($M), team size managed (direct + vendor), geography (countries, time zones), number of workstreams.

Customer Success Manager

- RETENTION: GRR (Gross Revenue Retention) %, churn rate reduced from X% to Y%, accounts saved from churning.
- EXPANSION: NRR (Net Revenue Retention) %, expansion ARR generated ($), upsell/cross-sell conversions closed.
- PORTFOLIO: Book of business size (ARR), number of accounts managed, segment (SMB / mid-market / enterprise — each implies different skills).
- ADOPTION: Feature adoption rate, onboarding completion %, time-to-first-value. Adoption precedes retention — show the link.
- HEALTH SCORE: Accounts moved from red to green/yellow, health score improvements, QBR completion rate.

8.6 Strong Action Verb Banks

PM: Defined • Launched • Shipped • Prioritized • Drove • Aligned • Synthesized • Designed • Led • Spearheaded • Championed • Reduced • Increased • Improved • Accelerated • Validated

PjM: Delivered • Managed • Led • Coordinated • Executed • Negotiated • Oversaw • Structured • Mitigated • Resolved • Governed • Facilitated • Tracked • Reported • Streamlined

CS: Managed • Grew • Retained • Expanded • Onboarded • Renewed • Recovered • Developed • Drove • Executed • Facilitated • Built • Partnered • Identified • Reduced

8.7 Before vs. After — PM / PjM / CS Bullets

✗ Vague (Never Write These)	✓ Specific (Write These Instead)
Managed the product roadmap	Prioritized Q3 roadmap across 42 initiatives using RICE scoring, aligning 4 engineering squads (22 engineers); 91% of prioritized features shipped on target
Worked with engineering to build features	Defined PRD for a bulk invoice processing feature based on 28 customer interviews; feature shipped in 6 weeks and drove 38% reduction in support tickets for billing queries
Ran user interviews to understand needs	Synthesized 45 user interviews into a JTBD framework that reframed the core use case; insight directly informed a pricing restructure that reduced churn by 19% in the enterprise segment
Managed projects end to end	Delivered a $6.5M SAP ERP rollout for a 2,800-user manufacturing client in 4 countries, 7 weeks ahead of schedule and $480K under budget — first on-time SAP delivery in the client's history
Worked with stakeholders across the business	Facilitated 18 executive steering committee reviews across 3 concurrent programmes, maintaining 95% action-item closure rate and zero unresolved red issues at board level
Managed customer accounts and relationships	Managed 14 enterprise accounts ($5.2M combined ARR), achieving 108% NRR in FY24 through structured expansion plays targeting adjacent departments within existing clients
Responsible for onboarding new customers	Designed a 60-day onboarding journey for mid-market accounts that reduced average time-to-first-value from 34 days to 11 days and increased D90 feature adoption from 41% to 78%
Helped with renewals and retention	Recovered 6 at-risk renewals ($1.1M ARR) by executing tailored executive engagement plans and facilitating product deep-dives with the CPO, resulting in multi-year contract extensions

PART 9 — CERTIFICATIONS (PM / PjM / CS)

9.1 Product Manager

- CSPO (Certified Scrum Product Owner) — widely recognized, especially in Agile-first organizations.
- PSPO (Professional Scrum Product Owner) — Scrum.org's version, considered more rigorous than CSPO.
- Product School Certificate — recognized by some companies, not universally respected. Less weight than CSPO/PSPO.
- Reforge Programs (Growth, Retention, Experimentation) — strong signal at growth-stage tech companies. Highly respected by senior PMs.
- Technical: SQL for Product Managers (Mode Analytics / Coursera), Google Analytics Certification — differentiating for data-driven PM roles.

9.2 Project Manager

- PMP (Project Management Professional, PMI) — the gold standard globally. Strongest single credential for senior PjM roles.
- PRINCE2 Practitioner — essential for UK, Europe, Australia, and government/public sector projects. Less recognized in the US.
- CSM (Certified Scrum Master) — important for Agile delivery roles or organizations running Scrum-based projects.
- PMI-ACP (Agile Certified Practitioner) — for PjMs managing mixed Agile-Waterfall environments.
- Six Sigma Green Belt / Black Belt — strong for operational excellence, manufacturing, supply chain, and process improvement roles.

9.3 Customer Success

- CCSM (Certified Customer Success Manager, SuccessCoaching) — the most established CS-specific certification.
- Gainsight Certification (Gainsight University) — valuable signal for roles at companies using Gainsight as their CS platform.
- Salesforce Certified Administrator / Sales Cloud Consultant — strong for CS roles where Salesforce is the primary CRM.
- LinkedIn Learning CSM Foundations — low credential weight but signals intentional self-development at entry level.
- HubSpot Customer Success Certification — relevant for SMB and startup CS roles using the HubSpot ecosystem.